Êdōâma dâ Enêoḳe

The Language of Raccoons · Nôu F

Overview

Êdōâma dâ Enêoḳe (translating to “language of raccoons”), also called Êdō in casual verbal conversation, is a conlang created by Noah Fountain with the purpose of communication. It is currently an unstable conlang (meaning it is still being changed and created actively).

The language uses Latin characters with and without accents. Accents serve as markers for sound changes among both vowels and consonants.

Phonology and Orthography

Vowels

ÊDE uses a set of five vowels along with diacritic marks to change their sounds.

Orthography	IPA	English Approximation
A-Â-Ā	/æ/-/eɪ/-/aʊ/	b**a**d-**a**te-r**ou**nd
E-Ê	/ɛ/-/iː/	b**e**d-b**ea**d
I-Î	/ɪ/-/aɪ/	b**i**g-**eye**
O-Ô-Ō	/ɔ/-/oʊ/-/uː/	n**o**t-b**oa**t-b**oo**t
U	/ʌ/	**u**p

Consonants

ÊDE also features eighteen consonants, with certain characters having accented variants to change sounds.

Orthography	IPA	English Approximation
B	/b/	**b**ed
D	/d/	**d**ea**d**
F	/f/	**f**ire
G-Ģ	/g/-/dʒ/	**g**ame-**j**ean
H	/h/	**h**ot
J	/j/	**y**es
K-Ķ-Ḱ	/k/-/s/-/sk/	**k**eep-**s**ea-**sc**ale
L	/l/	**l**ime
M	/m/	**m**an
N-Ņ	/n/-/ŋ/	**n**oo**n**-si**ng**
P	/p/	**p**um**p**
R	/ɹ/	**r**ed
T-Ţ	/t/-/θ/	**t**ack-**th**ink
V	/v/	**v**iolin
W	/w/	**w**in
X	/ks/	e**x**
Z-Ż-Ž	/z/-/ʃ/-/ʒ/	**z**ebra-**sh**e-mea**s**ure

All characters can be typed using the following:
For Windows: WinCompose
For phones: download Gboard → language settings → Santali (Latin), Latviešu (Latvija), and Čeština (Česko) on multilingual typing.

Stress

Stress is placed in a word's pronunciation in the first syllable containing a long or changed vowel (any vowel with a diacritic mark). In words with no diacritic, stress is placed on the first syllable of the word.

Grammar

Sentence Structure and Word Order

ÊDE generally follows the SVO sentence structure. This applies to all sentence types. Adjectives almost always follow the noun they modify.

Pronouns

Person	Singular	Plural
First	jo	jokô
Second	jot	jotkô
Third (masc.)	Ǧelêr	Ǧelêrkô
Third (fem.)	Žâlêr	Žâlêrkô
Third (neutral)	âlêr	âlêrkô
Third (inanimate)	kâlêr	kâlêrkô
Inquisitive	Hōn	—

To mark an indefinite pronoun, add the t' modifier at the beginning of the pronoun in the [mod]'[pronoun] format.

Possession

To mark a pronoun or noun as possessive, you add the ve' modifier in the [mod]'[word] format. This turns the word into an adjective; it is unaffected by the typical *post-noun adjective* rule.

Determiners

ÊDE has four determiners, all of which precede the noun they modify.

Determiner	Meaning
grō	the (definite article)
êtê	this/that
ol	all
kad	every

grō is used to denote something previously mentioned or commonly known. Nouns without a determiner are interpreted as indefinite by default.

grō nōżâ — "the night."

êtê enêoḳe — "this raccoon"

ol vênkô — "all humans"

kad dêja — "every day"

Helping Verb & Copula

In ÊDE, helping verbs and copulas share the same words, which only change based on person.

First Person	ḳô
Second Person	êroḳ
Third Person	êḳ

Helping Verb/Copula Tenses

To specify the relative time an action was done, add one of these modifiers to the beginning of the aux in [modifier]'[aux] format. These are unneeded when you are already talking in the specific tense or when talking in the present tense.

modifier	tense
p’	future
k’	past

Verb Aspects

To specify the aspect of a verb (continuous, perfect, etc.), add one of these modifiers to the beginning of a verb in the [modifier]’[verb] format. These are unneeded if you are talking in the simple aspect or do not want to specify.

Modifier	Aspect
ro’	continuous
li’	perfect
ge’	perfect continuous

Modifiers

Modifier	Part of Speech	Meaning
k’	auxiliary	Past tense
p’	auxiliary	Future tense
ro’	verb	Continuous aspect
li’	verb	Perfect aspect
ge’	verb	Perfect continuous aspect
t’	pronoun	Indefinite marker
ve’	pronoun & noun	Possessive marker

Part of Speech Changing

ÊDE lexicon has a base form that can be any part of speech (noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, etc.). The part of speech of a word can be changed by adding a suffix to the end.

Suffix	Part of Speech	Example
-ân	Adjective	*dōrmêķ* "rest" → *dōrmêķân* "asleep" (noun → adjective)
-âķ	Verb	*trelķōm* "crazy" → *trelķōmâķ* "to go crazy" (adjective → verb)
-ō	Object noun	*gif* "to give" → *gifō* "a gift" (verb → object noun)
-ōvên	Agent noun	*gif* "to give" → *gifōvên* "a giver" (verb → agent noun)

Pluralization

To make a word plural, you must add the *-kô* suffix. This comes from the word *kôgu*, meaning *multiple.*

Enêoķe “raccoon” → *Enêoķekô* “raccoons.”

Questions

Questions in ÊDE utilize the “hōn” inquisitive pronoun, which functions as a blank space for the answerer to fill in.

“Who are they?”	“Âlêr êḳ hōn?”
“What is that?”	“Kâlêr êḳ hōn?”
“What time is it?”	“Kronu êḳ hōn?”/”kronu?”
“Where?”	“Poḳê êḳ hōn?”/”Poḳê?”
“Why?”	“Razōn êḳ hōn?”/”Razōn?”
“How?”	“Vêtō êḳ hōn?”/”vêtō?”
“Which?”	“Hōn dâ êtê?”
“How many?”	“êtjōk êḳ hōn?”/”êtjōk?”
“Whose is this?”	“Êtê êḳ ve’hōn?”
“What time is night?”	“Kronu dâ nōżâ êḳ hōn?”

Numbers

ÊDE uses a base-10 number system. The digits 1–9 are as follows:

Number	Word
1	jōnê
2	kōd
3	ḱrat
4	rât
5	pedê
6	ķâtê
7	rōbon
8	kat
9	zôn

To express numbers beyond 9, use the place modifiers **lâ** and **lî** after a digit:

- **lâ** multiplies the digit by 10 per use
- **lî** multiplies the digit by 10,000 per use, and can stack infinitely

To express a non-zero remainder, use **[remainder] dâ [larger number]**. For example, **kat dâ kat lâ** = 88.

Expression	Value
jōnê lâ	10
jōnê lâ lâ	100
jōnê lâ lâ lâ	1,000
jōnê lî	10,000
jōnê lî lâ	100,000
jōnê lî lâ lâ	1,000,000
jōnê lî lî	100,000,000
jōnê lî lî lî	1,000,000,000,000

Naming conventions

When creating an ÊDE name, there are two paths to take. You can choose a loan name or a semantic name.

A loan name is when you adapt your own name to fit the phonology of ÊDE. For example: Noah → Nôu.

A semantic name is when a speaker chooses to be referred to by ÊDE words. For example, one may choose to be referred to as “enêoḳe” for their name.

Sample Sentences

ÊDE	English
Jo ķô enêoķe	I am a raccoon
žâlêr k'êķ mând pânêb	She ate bread
jokô p'ķô ro'dōrmêķâķ	We will be sleeping
ǵelêr êķ li'eķabâķ	He has written
jo ķô ro'mând ve'jo pânêb	I am eating my bread
ve'jot poķê êķ hōn?	Where are you?
jo k'ķô ge'dōrmêķâķ krorênō grō nōżâ	I had been sleeping during the night